

potentially reach the height our genes have programmed us to be. However, if we grow up without sunlight, with poor exercise and malnourishment, then our height may be stunted. In other words, our environment will positively or negatively affect our height potential.

Most people understand that a malnourished child will look far smaller and thinner than a nourished child. However, what they may not be able to piece together is that if the child's diet remains poor, the malnourished child may not achieve their potential height as a result. A person who had the genotype that allowed them to be 188 centimetres but had a very poor diet may only reach an adult height of 173 centimetres. It's only when we're educated on the effects of nurture that we can understand and plan for better outcomes.

Or we might observe a person sun baking and notice their skin becoming more tanned. From this observation and our own experience, we might quickly conclude that the sun has caused this. Now, we don't need to understand the scientific linkage between the sun and our skin darkening—because of our own experience and childhood skin sense campaigns, we understand the basic relationship between sun exposure and skin tanning.

But it's not always easy to come to such a straightforward conclusion. Did you know, for example, that flamingos are born white, not pink? The pink colour is actually caused by pigments in the organisms in their diet. But we cannot necessarily conclude this by observation alone because it's not our experience—it's through scientific research that we learned this.

Understanding our Financial Phenotype isn't as easy as observing darkened skin from sunbaking. It's more like observing the flamingo's change in colour. We can perhaps see the final financial result in someone else, but we don't understand how they arrived there. We understand suntanning and its health implications because we've had so much information about sun exposure from public health media campaigns or our schools and parents. Yet when it comes to observing our (or others') financial characteristics, we don't have that same breadth of language, education or understanding.

But the more we talk about money, the more aware we become of how we behave, and the more we learn how to observe our financial characteristics, the easier it will be to pinpoint our financial nature and